

The Other Person

June 8 - 29, 2025

Overview

This sermon series, titled The Other Person, explores the work of the Holy Spirit in the book of Acts, challenging the congregation to discern how the Spirit is moving in our lives and the church.

Beginning with I Love to Tell the Story, the series emphasizes the Holy Spirit's power to break cultural and traditional boundaries, as seen in the inclusion of Gentiles without adherence to Mosaic Law. The second sermon, Change of Plans, highlights the unpredictability of the Spirit's guidance, showcasing how faith and spiritual preparation equip believers to embrace unexpected missions and challenges. These themes build a foundation for recognizing the Spirit's transformative work in personal and communal contexts. The third sermon, There's a Wind a'Blowin', reflects on how trials and disruptions, such as the persecution in Acts 8, scatter believers into new opportunities for ministry and growth. Finally, Let's Eat Bacon addresses the Spirit's call to redefine purity and inclusion, as Peter learns to see Gentiles as clean and beloved in God's eyes.

Across the series, the congregation is invited to examine their biases, embrace challenges, and discern the Spirit's call to connect with those outside their comfort zones. By actively engaging with these lessons, the church is encouraged to trust the Spirit's unpredictable but purposeful leading, fostering growth and inclusivity in their faith community.

The success of this series will be evaluated by:

- To teach the congregation about discerning the Holy Spirit.
- Gather comments from the congregation about God's calling for our church.
- Give people the initial plans from our vision process.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
6/8/25	I Love To Tell The Story	Acts 15:1-11, 22-31 (and Acts 2)
6/15/25	Change of Plans	Acts 6:1-7; 13:1-3
6/22/25	There's a Wind a'Blowin	Acts 8:1-8, 14-15
6/29/25	Let's Eat Bacon	Acts 10:1-22

Summaries of the sermons created by ChatGPT.

Week 1 | I Love To Tell The Story | Acts 15:1-11, 22-31 (and Acts 2)

This sermon explores the transformative work of the Holy Spirit as seen in the book of Acts, focusing on Acts 15, where the early church grappled with the inclusion of Gentiles without requiring circumcision or adherence to the full Mosaic Law. The sermon highlights how the Holy Spirit led the apostles and elders to prioritize grace over cultural distinctiveness, showing that faith and testimony, rather than rigid adherence to tradition, mark true inclusion in the body of Christ. The decision at the Council of Jerusalem to simplify requirements for Gentiles symbolizes a profound shift, affirming that the gospel's power is universal and not confined to cultural or historical boundaries.

The preacher emphasizes that the work of the Holy Spirit often pushes believers beyond their comfort zones, requiring patience, scriptural engagement, and discernment of holy fruit, such as love and peace, as markers of Spirit-led change. This transformative process is exemplified in the testimonies of the early church leaders and the Gentiles, which reaffirmed the Spirit's guidance. The sermon challenges the congregation to embrace testimonies—personal and communal—as evidence of the Spirit's ongoing work and to recognize that

change, love, and connection across differences are the hallmarks of a Spirit-filled church. Through these reflections, the congregation is invited to listen actively to God's vision for their community and to be open to wherever the Spirit leads next.

Week 2 | Change of Plans | Acts 6:1-7; 13:1-3

This sermon reflects on the unpredictability of life and how the Holy Spirit works through unexpected changes, drawing from Acts 13:1-3, where the church in Antioch receives divine direction to set apart Barnabas and Saul for a mission. The preacher shares personal anecdotes contrasting their spontaneous nature with their spouse's preference for structure, illustrating how both their lives have followed unpredictable paths shaped by faith. The sermon emphasizes that life often involves changes in plans, as shown in the book of Acts, where early Christians like Peter, Paul, and Stephen faced unexpected callings and challenges.

The preacher connects these themes to modern experiences and how the Holy Spirit remains active even amid chaos. They highlight the importance of spiritual disciplines like worship, fasting, and prayer in preparing to discern and receive the Holy Spirit's guidance, even when it leads to surprising outcomes. The congregation is challenged to consider how they can prepare themselves and their church to hear and act on the Spirit's direction, trusting that God's plans, though unpredictable, are always purposeful and transformative.

Week 3 | There's a Wind a'Blowin | Acts 8:1-8, 14-15

This sermon, titled *What's Your Wind?*, reflects on the transformative power of trials and unexpected disruptions in life, as illustrated in Acts 8:1-8, 14-15. It begins with the persecution of the early church, which scattered believers throughout Judea and Samaria, ultimately leading to the spread of the gospel in ways they could not have anticipated. The preacher connects this narrative to beloved stories of triumph over adversity, such as *The Lion King* and *Remember the Titans*, emphasizing the universal appeal of finding beauty in tragedy and

success through sacrifice. The scattered believers, like Philip in Samaria, turned their misfortunes into opportunities for revival, demonstrating the Holy Spirit's ability to bring purpose and growth out of upheaval.

The sermon challenges the congregation to view obstacles not as setbacks but as winds that scatter and propel believers into new opportunities for ministry and connection. The preacher highlights how Christians, by their nature, accept the possibility of sacrificing comfort and security to live fully into discipleship. Drawing parallels to the church's challenges, the sermon celebrates the resilience of the faith community and its ability to adapt and thrive in unexpected ways. The congregation is invited to consider how the Holy Spirit is scattering people today and how they might be called to meet and minister to those who are outside traditional church spheres, fulfilling Jesus' call to go to "Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria, and the ends of the earth."

Week 4 | Let's Eat Bacon | Acts 10:1-22

This sermon, titled Let's Eat Bacon, delves into the transformative story in Acts 10:1-22, where Peter receives a vision challenging his lifelong understanding of purity and inclusion. The narrative begins with Cornelius, a devout Roman centurion, having a vision to summon Peter. Simultaneously, Peter, while praying, has a vision of unclean animals and hears God's command to eat, symbolizing a radical shift in divine standards of cleanliness. Initially resistant due to his Jewish upbringing, Peter learns from God not to call anything impure that He has made clean. This realization prepares Peter to meet Cornelius and embrace a broader understanding of God's inclusive mission.

The preacher connects Peter's story to modern struggles with bias and exclusivity, challenging the congregation to reconsider who they might label as "unclean" based on societal or personal standards. Through anecdotes and reflection, the sermon emphasizes the Holy Spirit's role in propelling believers toward new perspectives, relationships, and missions. Congregants are invited to discern who in their lives might be overlooked or dismissed and to see all people as clean in God's eyes. The sermon concludes with a call for active

participation in the church's discernment process, underscoring the transformative power of embracing God's grace.